MASTER FUNCTIONAL SKILLS

FUNCTIONAL SKILLS MATHEMATICS

LEVEL 2

CORE REVISION GUIDE • MODEL ANSWERS



MATHEMATICS
CORE STUDY GUIDE

Complete 39-standard curriculum guide with Section A & Section B model solutions

39 Standards | Sec A Non-Calc | Sec B Calculator | Worked Solutions

OFQUAL REGULATED SPECIFICATION • 2026/2027 EDITION

OFFICIAL STUDY MANUAL

Statutory Subject Content Mapping

The Reformed Functional Skills Mathematics Level 2 specification covers 39 statutory learning outcomes across three core curriculum domains. Every section in this guide is mapped directly to these standards:

Domain	DfE Content Codes	Key Focus Areas & Examination Weighting
1. Using Numbers & the Number System	L2.1 – L2.11	Fractions, Decimals, Percentages, Ratio, Compound Interest, Section A Non-Calc Mental Strategies (25% marks).
2. Measures, Shape & Space	L2.12 – L2.27	Perimeter & Circumference, Area of Compound Shapes, Prisms & Cylinders Volume, Density, Speed & Scale Drawings (40% marks).
3. Handling Data & Information	L2.28 – L2.39	Mean from Grouped Frequency Tables, Scatter Graphs & Correlation, Probability Trees, Range & Two-Way Tables (35% marks).

Exam Structure & Timing

- **Section A (Non-Calculator):** 25 Minutes • 16 Marks (Mental arithmetic, long division, fraction operations)
- **Section B (Calculator):** 1 Hour 30 Minutes • 48 Marks (Multi-step workplace problem solving)
- **Total Qualification Standard:** 64 Marks • Typical Pass Boundary: 36–40 Marks (56–62%)

Stepped Model Solution: Compound Garden Tiling

Exam Prompt (5 Marks):
Sarah is laying artificial turf and paving slabs in an L-shaped garden. The total garden is 12m long by 8m wide, with a 4m by 5m patio cutout. Turf costs £8.50 per square metre. Sarah has a budget of £650. *Can Sarah afford to turf the remaining area? Show all your working.*

Step-by-Step Examiner Benchmark Method:

Step 1: Calculate Total Rectangle Area — **[M1 Method Mark]**
Area_total = 12m × 8m = 96 m^2

Step 2: Calculate Cutout Patio Area — **[M1 Method Mark]**
Area_patio = 4m × 5m = 20 m^2

Step 3: Subtract to Find Lawn Area to Turf — **[A1 Accuracy Mark]**
Lawn Area = 96 m^2 − 20 m^2 = 76 m^2

Step 4: Calculate Total Cost of Turf — **[M1 Method Mark]**
Cost = 76 × £8.50 = £646.00

Step 5: Compare with Budget & State Clear Decision — **[A1 Final Decision]**
£646.00 is less than £650.00 (£4 under budget). **Yes, Sarah can afford it.**

Official Examiner Trap Alert:
Many candidates calculate the cost correctly as £646.00 but fail to write the final concluding statement ("Yes, she can afford it"). In Pearson Edexcel and City & Guilds mark schemes, the final accuracy mark is strictly conditional upon stating a definitive "Yes" or "No".

Everything you need to pass Functional Skills Maths Level 2

The definitive preparation manual for candidates aiming for a pass at Level 2 (GCSE 4/C Equivalent). Master non-calculator mental arithmetic, multi-step compound calculations, fractions, decimals, percentages, perimeter, area, volume, scatter graphs, and probability.

INSIDE THIS PUBLICATION

- ✔ **All 39 Curriculum Standards:** Exhaustive coverage of Number, Measure & Shape, and Handling Data mapped to Pearson Edexcel and City & Guilds.
- ✔ **Section A Non-Calculator Strategy:** Fast-track mental arithmetic, grid multiplication, long division, and fraction manipulations.
- ✔ **Section B Multi-Step Problems:** Stepped breakdowns of 4-to-6 mark complex workplace scenarios showing exact method mark allocation.
- ✔ **Official Examiner Trap Alerts:** Highlighting frequent calculation blunders, unit omission errors, and rounding pitfalls.
- ✔ **Complete Worked Model Answers:** Every question includes full intermediate workings so you know exactly how marks are earned.

Pair with the Companion Practice Workbook:

For extensive hands-on calculation practice, pair this Core Study Guide with the *Functional Skills Maths Level 2 Companion Practice Workbook* containing 120+ stepped drills and blank method workspaces.

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